

Section B (Synoptic Investigation): **One** question with **three** parts.

A2 Unit 4: Geographical Research***Unit code 6GE04**

- Externally assessed
- Availability: January and June
- First assessment: January 2010

**40%
of the
total A2
marks****20% of
the total
GCE
marks****Content summary:**

Options range from those with a strong physical geography focus, to those concerned more with environmental, social and cultural geographies. Students must select and study **one** of the following research options:

- Option 1: Tectonic Activity and Hazards
- Option 2: Cold Environments — Landscapes and Change
- Option 3: Life on the Margins — the Food Supply Problem
- Option 4: The World of Cultural Diversity
- Option 5: Pollution and Human Health at Risk
- Option 6: Consuming the Rural Landscape — Leisure and Tourism.

Assessment:

1 hour and 30 minute examination. Candidates will be given a list of questions based on the **six** options. Candidates will select and answer **one** question that relates to the option they have studied.

B Specification overview

Summary of assessment requirements

Unit number and unit title	Level	Assessment information	Number of marks allocated in the unit
Unit 1: Global Challenges	AS	1 hour and 30 minute examination paper comprising of two sections and a resource booklet. Candidates will be asked to answer all questions in Section A and one question in Section B. Section A will make use of the resource booklet and consist of objective items, data response and short answer questions. Section B will also make use of the resource booklet and candidates' own ideas and consist of a choice of Going Global or World at Risk longer/guided essay questions. There are a total of 90 marks for the complete examination.	90 marks
Unit 2: Geographical Investigations	AS	1 hour examination including examination paper comprising of two sections and a resource booklet. Candidates will select and answer one physical question from Section A and one human question from Section B based on the topics they have studied for Unit 2. The questions require longer responses, each with three parts, designed to include data response, investigation and evaluation skills and related impacts/management issues. Candidates will be expected to use the resource booklet provided and their own ideas from relevant fieldwork and research that they have carried out. Candidates must not take materials into the examination. There are a total of 70 marks for the examination.	70 marks

Unit number and unit title	Level	Assessment information	Number of marks allocated in the unit
Unit 3: Contested Planet	A2	2 hour and 30 minute examination paper comprising of two sections and a resource booklet including synoptic resources. The synoptic resources only will be pre-released to candidates as advance information four working weeks before the examination via the Edexcel website (www.edexcel.org.uk). There is no restriction on the use of pre-released synoptic resources in teaching prior to the examination. Candidates must not take their pre-released synoptic resources into the examination as these will be reproduced in the resource booklet. Candidates will be asked to select and answer two questions from five in Section A and all questions in Section B. Section A will consist of a choice of two data stimulus essay questions from five each totalling 25 marks. The five questions will be based on five of the six topics for Unit 3. Section B (Synoptic investigation) will focus on the sixth topic unexamined in Section A. This topic will change in each exam sitting and will be revealed through the pre-released advance information. Section B will consist of one question in three parts. The total mark for the question will be 40. The question will make use of the pre-released synoptic materials reproduced in the examination resource booklet. There are a total of 90 marks for the complete examination.	90 marks
Unit 4: Geographical Research	A2	1 hour and 30 minute examination. Research focus material will be pre-released to candidates as advance information four working weeks before the examination via the Edexcel website (www.edexcel.org.uk). Candidates will be given a list of questions based on the six options. Candidates will select and answer one question that relates to the option they have studied. They will be required to write a long essay in which they demonstrate and synthesise the results of their research. Each question is out of 70 marks. Candidates will not be able to take any pre-released or research materials into the examination.	70 marks

Assessment objectives and weightings

		% in AS	% in A2	% in GCE
AO1	Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the content, concepts and processes.	60%	40%	50%
AO2	Analyse, interpret and evaluate geographical information, issues and viewpoints and apply understanding in unfamiliar contexts.	24%	26%	25%
AO3	Select and use a variety of methods, skills and techniques (including the use of new technologies) to investigate questions and issues, reach conclusions and communicate findings.	16%	34%	25%
TOTAL		100%	100%	100%

Relationship of assessment objectives to units

Unit number	Assessment objective			
	AO1	AO2	AO3	Total for AO1, AO2 and AO3
Unit 1	22%	8%	0%	30%
Unit 2	8%	4%	8%	20%
Unit 3	14%	8%	8%	30%
Unit 4	6%	5%	9%	20%
Total for Advanced GCE	50%	25%	25%	100%

Qualification summary

Subject criteria

The General Certificate of Education is part of the Level 3 provision. This specification is based on the Advanced Subsidiary GCE and Advanced Level GCE subject criteria for Geography; these are prescribed by the regulatory authorities and are mandatory for all awarding bodies.

Aims

The aims of the Edexcel Advanced Level GCE in Geography are to:

- develop and apply their understanding of geographical concepts and processes to understand and interpret our changing world
- develop their awareness of the complexity of interactions within and between societies, economies, cultures and environments at scales from local to global
- develop as global citizens who recognise the challenges of sustainability and the implications for their own and others' lives
- improve as critical and reflective learners aware of the importance of attitudes and values, including their own
- become adept in the use and application of skills and new technologies through their geographical studies both in and outside the classroom
- be inspired by the world around them, and gain enjoyment and satisfaction from their geographical studies and understand their relevance.

AS/A2 knowledge, understanding and skills

This Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE specification requires students to:

- develop knowledge and understanding of selected physical, human and environmental processes that underpin key geographical concepts
- develop a knowledge and understanding of the key concepts of place, space, diversity, interdependence, people–environment interaction, the processes associated with these, and change over time
- study at a range of scales and understand the importance of scale as a geographical idea
- use a range of skills and techniques, including the use of maps and images at different scales necessary for geographical study
- carry out research, and out-of-classroom work including fieldwork, as appropriate to the topics selected
- use modern information technologies, including geographical information systems (GIS), as appropriate to the content
- develop understanding of the application and relevance of geography.

**A2 knowledge,
understanding and
skills**

In addition, the Edexcel Advanced GCE specification requires students to:

- undertake individual research/investigative work, including fieldwork
- extend their understanding of geographical ideas, concepts and processes
- identify and analyse the connections between the different aspects of geography
- analyse and synthesise geographical information in a variety of forms and from a range of sources
- consider new ideas and developments about the changing nature of geography in the 21st century
- critically reflect on and evaluate the potential and limitations of approaches and methods used both in and outside the classroom.

C Geography unit content

Unit 1 Global Challenges	17
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Unit 2 Geographical Investigations	31
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Unit 3 Contested Planet	49
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Unit 4 Geographical Research	71
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Course structure

- Edexcel's GCE in Geography comprises four units and contains an Advanced Subsidiary subset of two AS units.
- The Advanced Subsidiary GCE is the first half of the GCE course and consists of Units 1 and 2. It may be awarded as a discrete qualification or contribute 50 per cent to the total Advanced GCE marks.
- The full Advanced GCE award consists of the two AS units (Units 1 and 2), plus two A2 units (Units 3 and 4) which make up the other 50 per cent of the Advanced GCE. Students wishing to take the full Advanced GCE must, therefore, complete all four units.
- The structure of this qualification allows teachers to construct a course of study which can be taught and assessed either as:
 - ◆ distinct modules of teaching and learning with related units of assessment taken at appropriate stages during the course; or
 - ◆ a linear course which is assessed in its entirety at the end.